



INDIAN LAW & DEALMAKING · 23 AUGUST 2026

Five moves shaping the board now.

- › Delhi HC quashes Aristo PMLA case
- › Delhi HC denies Ram Singh PMLA bail
- › Supreme Court stays NCLAT easement ruling
- › Chennai NCLAT protects scheme proponent EMD
- › Aditya Birla Group launches capital plan

SWIPE →



DELHI HIGH COURT · PMLA

01 / 05

Delhi High Court quashes Aristo Group PMLA case

On 18 August 2026, the Delhi High Court quashed the ED ECIR and PMLA proceedings against the late Mahendra Prasad, Aristo Group, and family members. The Court ruled that the ED cannot sustain money-laundering charges by adding an older FIR after the primary predicate offence was legally closed.

THE READ

Predicate closure is an absolute bar against fresh ED investigations. Enforcers can no longer revive dead cases through late procedural addendums.



DELHI HIGH COURT · PMLA

02 / 05

Delhi High Court denies Ram Singh anticipatory bail

On 18 August 2026, Justice Madhu Jain of the Delhi High Court dismissed Ram Singh's anticipatory-bail plea in an ED money-laundering case involving Babaji Finance Group. The Court held that protection granted in the predicate FIR does not automatically extend to independent PMLA proceedings.

THE READ

PMLA proceedings maintain strict procedural autonomy from predicate FIRs. Protection in the base crime offers zero shelter against separate money-laundering arrest.



SUPREME COURT · IBC

03 / 05

Supreme Court stays NCLAT easementary right ruling

On 20 August 2026, the Supreme Court stayed an NCLAT ruling that allowed the NCLT to resolve an easementary right-of-way dispute tied to liquidation assets in ARC Research and Development Centre Ltd v Liquidator of Adya Oils and Chemicals Ltd. The bench referred the parties to its Mediation Centre.

THE READ

Insolvency tribunals cannot easily trespass into traditional civil property disputes. Asset value maximisation under the IBC must respect established jurisdictional boundaries.



NCLAT CHENNAI · IBC

04 / 05

Chennai NCLAT protects scheme proponent earnest money

On 22 August 2026, NCLAT Chennai held that a liquidation-scheme proponent cannot be compelled to forfeit its earnest money deposit after withdrawing an unaccepted proposal. The ruling shields prospective bidders from arbitrary liquidator retentions during distressed asset sales.

THE READ

Bid security remains protected until a scheme is formally accepted and binding. Liquidators cannot penalize bidders for walking away from unapproved proposals.



Aditya Birla Group announces thirty billion investment

On 22 August 2026, Aditya Birla Group disclosed a thirty billion dollar investment programme spanning group businesses. The allocation includes ten billion for Hindalco, six billion for telecom expansion, two billion for renewables, and two billion for green fibre and carbon black.

THE READ

Massive capital allocation across metals and telecom will trigger heavy transaction flow. Expect cascading opportunities in acquisition financing and project contracting.



THE THROUGH-LINE

Recent judicial interventions this week draw sharp boundaries around regulatory overreach and tribunal jurisdiction across the corporate landscape. From strict procedural checks on enforcement agencies to preserving civil property boundaries in insolvency, courts are reasserting predictable legal baselines. Against this backdrop of disciplined oversight, major capital deployment signals robust long-term industrial momentum.





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